

R2-D2 Tamagotchi

R2-D2, the beloved droid from Star Wars, is now officially a Tamagotchi toy. Sure is a few decades late, but you know what they say, better late than never. The iconic droid can now be carried around with you in your pocket. The R2-D2 Tamagotchi comes in two colours, a retro looking translucent blue colour, and a white colour. Both colour options have a design that resembles the droid's chassis. The models look identical to the OG Tamagotchis people purchased

back in the day.

That's seemingly not the only thing that's identical, the gameplay experience is also the same. That being said, most of us here probably never owned a Tamagotchi in our lives. The R2-D2 Tamagotchi features a 24x30p LCD display and three physical buttons.



You can train your R2-D2 in 19 different skills, take care of it by cleaning and charging it up to keep it happy, and there's also nine included mini-games you can play. This is the first official Tamagotchi to feature R2-D2, however, Tiger Electronics did something similar way back in 1997 with their 'Giga Pet' version of R2-D2.



TechTics BeachBot

Edwin Bos and fellow entrepreneur Martijn Lukaart have built a beach-cleaning machine that can spot cigarette butts and dispose of them. BeachBot or BB uses artificial intelligence to learn how to find the cigarette butts, even if they're partially buried under the sand. BeachBot has already successfully completed one demo at the Scheveningen Beach last September during World Cleanup Day. Another demo is scheduled for later this year. Cigarette butts are full of microplastics, which are pretty bad for the environment, and these often get into the ocean as well. These butts often contain chemicals that are considered toxic to aquatic life. 4.5 trillion butts end up in nature every year, and they can take up to 14 years to degrade. To train BB, TechTics showed the BeachBot thousands of photos of cigarette butts lying around on the beach, in different positions so it can recognise them even when they're partially hidden. They used Microsoft Trove to help collect these photos, which is an app that connects AI devs to photo takers. TechTics pays contributors 25 cents per accepted image.

Steam Deck

We have known that Valve was working on a handheld device for a little while, and now it's finally here. The device is dubbed the 'Steam Deck'. From the looks of it, it looks very similar to the Nintendo Switch. According to Valve, the Steam Deck is optimised for handheld gaming. "It is a Zen 2 + RDNA 2 powerhouse, delivering more than enough performance to run the latest AAA games in a very efficient power envelope." The Steam Deck's design is also optimised for comfortable and "extended play sessions." Your entire Steam library will be available to you on the

Steam Deck. Additionally, there's also a dock which you can purchase separately that will allow you to connect the Steam Deck to your TV or monitor.

The Steam Deck sports a 7-inch LCD screen (unlike the Switch's OLED screens), which makes it slightly larger than Nintendo's Switch screens. However, the controllers aren't detachable, like they are on the Switch. The Deck's battery life is reported at between 2-8 hours, depending on the frames you limit it to. The device runs SteamOS out of the box, but you can install third-party software and OS.

